GOALS OF CARE



One in three high-risk patients choosing surgery will experience serious medical complications leading to long-term decline in health and quality of life. Often patients do not receive the information they need to make an informed decision about surgery. [1]

Shared decision making is a collaborative process between clinicians and patients, which aims to select the most suitable treatment option based on best available evidence and informed patient preferences. [1]

Screening Tools

- Do you have an advanced care plan - a list of instructions to help guide a trusted person to make healthcare treatment decisions on your behalf if required?
- Have you identified a substitute decision maker - someone you trust to make healthcare treatment decisions on your behalf if you are unable to do it yourself?
- Is the patient at higher risk of perioperative complications? (e.g., advanced age, frailty, poor functional capacity, moderate/highly invasive surgery, multiple comorbidities)

Optimization is recommended for patients that answer No to question 1 or 2, or Yes to question 3.

Prehabilitation and Optimization Recommendations

Patient Education	Refer to online patient resources
Preoperative Goals of Care Discussion	Use the best-case scenario / worst-case scenario framework [2]
Referral for Comprehensive Geriatric Assessment (CGA)	Consider preoperative assessment by Geriatrics to delineate risk